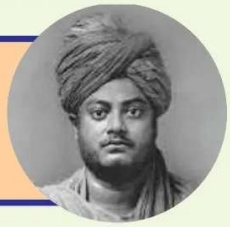
Chapter 9

THE EASTERN KINGDOMS

I discard the idea that India was ever passive .

- Swami Vivekananda



LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Describe about the Eastern Ganga kingdoms and their contributions in the field of architecture.
- Appreciate the bravery of the Ahoms and their contributions to Bharat.
- List out a few marvels of north-eastern Bharat.

INTRODUCTION

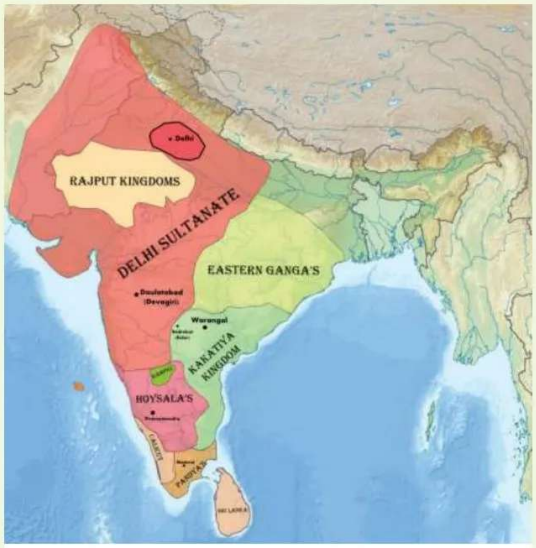
The northern parts of Bharat had come under the rule of the Mamluks by the 12th century and the Delhi Sultanate had been established. While there were many kingdoms that were taken over, kingdoms like the Eastern Ganga valiantly resisted these invasions. The Eastern Ganga kingdom consisted of today's Odisha, portions of southern Bengal and northern Andhra Pradesh. Cuttack served as the capital of the Eastern Ganga kingdom.

THE EASTERN GANGA RULERS AND BEYOND

In 1238 CE, Narasimhadeva I took over the throne of Odisha. His reign till 1264 CE was filled with glory for Odisha. His administration of the kingdom and military policy are considered an extraordinary period in Odisha's history.

The Eastern Ganga kingdom attained great heights in strength and respect. Narasimhadeva I was also world renowned for building the Sun temple in Konark that had Suryadeva (Sun God) as the presiding deity.

The temple is made of stone and in the form of a huge chariot drawn by horses. There are 24 wheels that are carved in the temple complex. These wheels are actually sun dials. Each wheel has 8 major spokes that divides the 24 hours in a day. Hence, the time span between two major spokes is 3 hours. There are 8 minor spokes that run in the middle of two major spokes. Thus the time span between a major spoke and a minor spoke is 90 minutes.



Bharat in 1325 CE

At the edge of the wheel there are many beads and there are exactly 30 beads between a major spoke and a minor spoke. Thus, each bead is equivalent to 3 minutes. Each bead is large enough for our eye to see if the shadow is falling at the centre of the bead or at its ends.

Thus we can calculate time accurately to one minute. If you were to place a pen at the tail of the animal in the axle, the shadow will fall on the edge of the wheel. Note the bead where the shadow falls and calculate the time!



Sun Temple, Konark



Wheel of time-Sun Temple, Konark



Sun Temple, Konark

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

Each wheel in the Konark Sun temple are sun dials. Did you understand how people were able to tell time using the sun dial? Now, create a sun dial and attempt to tell the time to an accuracy of 1 minute.

GROWTH OF THE EMPIRE UNDER NARASIMHADEVA I

In 1234 CE, Narasimhadeva attacked northern Radha (current day Bengal) which was under the Delhi Sultanate. Tugril Khan was the governor of the state. Terrified by the advance of Narasimhadeva I, Tugril Khan launched a counter-offensive on Narasimhadeva's forces. They were forced to retreat to their frontier fort of Katasin. This was a well calculated move by Narasimhadeva I. The fort was well built and surrounded by dense forests. Narasimhadeva I further fortified the place by digging trenches that slowed down the advancing armies of Tugril Khan. Tugril Khan chased down Narasimhadeva's forces to Katasin. Thinking that he had the upper hand he was resting in the forest areas around Katasin, when Narasimhadeva's forces launched guerilla attacks on the Islamic forces and routed them. The Radha province of Bengal was captured.

Tugril Khan sought help from Delhi, Awadh and other regions to counter Narasimhadeva. They all responded by coming to Odisha and laying siege to Rajmahal hills. Narasimhadeva I launched a fierce attack on the joint forces in Lakhnauti and drove the enemies out of the region. The provinces of Rarh and Varendra were taken over by Narasimhadeva I. Narasimhadeva I ensured that he drove the enemy forces out from Rajmahal hills. Thus, Bengal was no longer a threat to Odisha. Narasimhadeva I's aggressive and successful campaigns against the invading forces greatly saved northern Bharat.


Lakhnauti Fort

AFTER NARASIMHADEVA I

By 1264 CE, the great rule of Narasimhadeva I came to an end. It was from the time of Narasimhadeva I that the Ganga rulers adopted the title of Gajapati probably due to the large regiment of elephants that they had in their army. After Narasimhadeva, Bhanudeva I took over the throne followed by Narasimha II. Narasimha II's reign was relatively peaceful and he was able to expand the trade and commerce of his kingdom leading to a period of prosperity till 1306 CE. Narasimha II was succeeded by his son Bhanudeva II. The Ganga empire shrunk during his times. Iliyas Shah, the sultan of Bengal invaded Odisha and slaughtered people. He ransacked the famous Puri Jagannath temple and carried away a great amount of wealth including 44 elephants. Successive rulers of the dynasty could not take on the Sultans of Delhi and Bengal and the royal family was in shambles.


Jagannath Temple, Puri

44 elephants in today's money value is about Rs. 220 lakhs

DID YOU KNOW?

BEGINNING OF GAJAPATI KINGDOM

The last ruler of the Eastern Ganga empire was king Bhanudeva IV. He was in constant battle with the neighboring kingdoms of Reddis and Vijayanagara. This made Bhanudeva to go south to combat against the Vijayanagara forces. His long absence in Cuttack led his ministers to raise a new ruler – Kapilendra – and installed him on the throne in 1434 CE. This marked the beginning of the Gajapatis of Odisha.

RAJA KAPILENDRA


Gajapati Kapilendradeva, Kapileshwar Temple Bhubaneshwar

Kapilendra immediately set out on consolidating and expanding the influence of his kingdom. By 1443 CE, he captured Vishakapatnam district, Godavari delta and Kondavidu. Kapilendra was also able to capture territories in Bengal including the Mandaran fort in Hooghly.

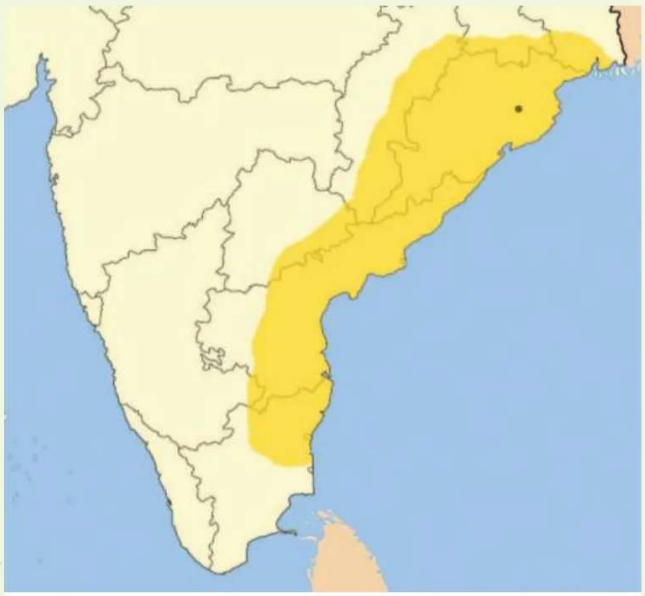
Odisha saw its common folks massacred and temples destroyed by Mahmud Shah, ruler of Jaunpur, around 1445 CE. The Bahmani ruler also kept fighting over the Telangana border regions that greatly troubled Kapilendra.



Southern Bharat 1400 CE

FURTHER EXPANSION OF THE KINGDOM

The Bahmani forces attacked Devarakonda, the stronghold of the Velamas. The Velamas appealed to Kapilendra who sent his eldest son Hamvira to assist the Velamas. Hamvira and his army descended upon the Bahmani army and thoroughly defeated them. They were pursued by the brave Hamvira into the desert regions. The Bahmani army resources, elephants and horses were taken over by Hamvira. In 1461 CE, Humayun Shah died and was succeeded by his son Nizam shah who was just 8 years old. Kapilendra seized this opportunity and advanced into the Bahmani kingdom and reached within ten miles of their capital.



Gajapati kingdom under Kapilendradeva

Hamvira set out and conquered Udayagiri and then Chandragiri. He then moved towards the south to reach Kanchi and the Cauvery delta in 1464 CE.

Kapilendra was able to reach till Vijayawada and around 1467 CE passed away. Under Kapilendra, Odisha stretched from the lower Ganga in the north to Kaveri in the south. Before his death, Kapilendra had nominated his younger son, Purushottama, to succeed him.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

Map the growth of the kingdom under Kapilendra by following the sequence of regions captured by him.

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DECLINE OF EASTERN GANGA EMPIRE

The Bahmani sultan Muhammad III invaded Odisha after 1471 CE. The attack was swift and Purushottama was forced to purchase peace through tributes and wealth. Muhammad also advanced against Hamvira at Kondavidu. Hamvira was forced to surrender. Muhammad III died in 1482. This helped Purushottama to reconquer Udayagiri and maintain the peace till his death in 1497 CE.

Shrewd and effective in military matters, Kapilendra may have missed the need to develop alliances with the Vijayanagara rulers to combat the rulers of Bengal and the Deccan. Infact the hostilities with Vijayanagara and the Bengal and Bahmani sultans proved to be the reason for the kingdom's decline.

AHOMS

THE GEOGRAPHY

In 13th century Assam, the Kamarupa kingdom continued under different rulers and names. The Karatoya river in Bengal formed its western boundary. The eastern boundary changed from time to time. The frontiers of Assam was very fragmented and under many independent chiefs called **Baro Bhuyas**.



The eastern part of Assam was getting consolidated by the Shan tribe who were known as the **Ahoms**. They were growing by assimilating into the local population and growing into a large community. There were also many small princely states, especially the **Cacharis** and **Chutiyas**.

The Chutiya kingdom extended between the Subarnasri river and Disang river. The Ahoms were keen to integrate the Chutiya kingdom into their fold and were successful after a few battles Southwest of the Chutiya kingdom lay the Cachari kingdom which extended from the Brahmaputra river till the Dhansiri river.

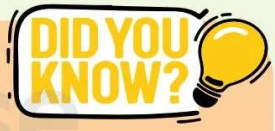
The Kamata kingdom in the west (sometimes referred to as Kamarupa by Muslim chroniclers) and the Ahom kingdom in the east were the primary kingdoms that were sizeable and powerful.

CONSOLIDATION OF KAMATA AND AHOM

Under the Kamata king **Durlabh Narayan**, the kingdom is recorded to have flourished in the late 13th century. However there were constant battles with the Ahoms. To get over the fighting, an alliance between the two kingdoms was cemented by the marriage of the Kamata princess Bhajani with the Ahom king Sukhangpha.

There were some regions in the southern part of Kamarupa including Mymensingh and Sylhet that were under the rule of **Dharina Narayan**, a cousin of Durlabh Narayan. The regions under his control were attacked by the Bengal sultan and Sylhet was captured in 1303 CE. Using Sylhet as a base a few other regions like Chittagong and Tippera (Tripura) were annexed.

Despite these invasions, by the early 15th century Kamata regained its glory under the Khens who were native to the region. **Nilambara** was one of the most powerful rulers of Kamata. He is credited with having constructed a highway between his capital city of Kamatapur and Ghoraghat (Rangpur district). Under his leadership the kingdom was extensive and included the geographical areas mentioned in the introduction including Goalpiara, Kamarupa, Sylhet and Mymensingh.



This great king Nilambara had fought two powerful sultans of Bengal, Ruknuddin Barbak Shah and Alauddin Husain Shah and successfully defended the kingdom.

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THE EARLY AHOM RULERS AND THEIR GROWTH

Between 1215 CE and 1293 CE, the Ahoms were ruled by **Sukapha** followed by **Suteupha** and then **Subinpha**. They were able to establish the Ahom kingdom and govern a consolidated region in Assam.

In the late 13th century, Sukhangpha married tha Kamata princess and the kingdoms became strong allies. After the death of Sukhangpha, his three sons ruled the kingdom between 1332 and 1389. Besides a worsening relationship with the Chutiyas, this period was relatively uneventful.

AHOMS AND KAMATA UNITE AGAINST INVADERS

In 1397 CE, Sudangpha started his reign and established his capital at Charguya near the Dihing river. During this time there were some hostilities with the Kamata king. The sultan of Bengal Ghiyasudin Azam Shah wanted to use the rift between the Ahoms and Kamata and tried to invade Kamata. Ahom and Kamata set aside their differences and joined hands and drove Ghiyasudin and his armies beyond the Karatoya borders.

AHOM KINGDOM EXPANDS ITS BORDERS

The Ahom kingdom had many rulers till 1497 CE when Suhungmung took over the leadership. Sunhungmung assumed the name of Svarga Narayan. Key changes in the Ahom region effected during Svarga Narayan's rule include:

- The capital was shifted from Charguya to Bakata.
- The Aitonia Naga kingdom was defeated and they paid tributes to the Ahoms.
- Between 1513 and 1523, there was prolonged fight with the Chutiya kingdom at the end of which the Ahoms won over the Chutiyas.



Ahom kingdom 16th century CE

- In 1526 CE, Svarga Narayan led an army against the Cachari kingdom. He reached deep into the Cachari kingdom. By 1531 CE Svarga Narayan reached Dimapur, the capital city of the Cacharis. The Ahoms established complete control over the Cacharis.

AHOMS VS THE SULTAN OF BENGAL

In 1527 CE, the sultan of Bengal Nusrat Shah advanced towards the Ahom territory. The Ahoms fought bravely and defeated them. The Ahoms drove out their enemies past the Burai river capturing many weapons, artillery and resources.

In 1532 CE, Turbak Khan led a large force to the Ahom kingdom and took control over some of the key forts of the Ahoms. The Ahoms reinvented their war strategy. Turbak Khan was getting his supply of soldiers, weapons, food and other resources from Gauda kingdom (Bengal) in a way that cut off the supply of these resources.

BATTLE OF LAKHNAUTI	
When?	1533 CE
Where?	Duimunsila, Kaliabar, Assam
Who were the combatants?	
Ahoms	Bengal and Delhi Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Suhungmung, Tonkham	Turbak Khan
Outcome : Turbak Khan loses	
SIGNIFICANCE : For the first time, Ahoms use modern firearms. Mughals and Bengal Sultanate never return to the region for a long period.	

Turbak Khan knew that his supply lines were compromised but pushed forward into Ahom territory. The Ahoms starved the supply lines of Turbak's army and then conducted guerilla attacks. These guerilla attacks kept reducing the number of soldiers in Turbak's army. Now that the Ahoms had further weakened Turbak's army, the battle of Lakhnauti took place in Duimunsila. The Ahom naval power actively targeted Turbak's army and naval fleet, resulting in Turbak Khan's forces losing 22 ships, numerous weapons, and thousands of soldiers in the confrontation.

Weapons, a large quantity of gold and silver, guns, elephants and horses were captured by the Ahoms.

Svarga Narayan (Suhungmung) was one of the greatest Ahom rulers who successfully resisted the invaders while also expanding his kingdom. Unfamiliar with the firearms of the invaders, the Ahoms compensated for this military gap by employing traditional weapons like swords, spears, bows, and local armaments. Upon acquiring firearms, they swiftly learned their use, bolstering their defensive capabilities.

MULA GABHARU



In 1533 CE, when the Ahoms were fighting against the forces of Turbak Khan, there was an Ahom commander called **Phrasengmung Borgohain**. Borgohain is a title given by the Ahom king and it signifies that he was second in rank in the council of ministers. During the battle with Turbak Khan Phrasengmung was killed by Turbak using treachery. This demoralized the Ahom forces. Sensing this, Mula Gabharu, Phrasengmung's wife, stepped into the battlefield and started striking terror in the ranks of Turbak's army. The Ahom army fought again with renewed energy as Mula Gabharu went around the battlefield fighting valorously. Over the next couple of days Mula Gabharu killed some of Turbak's key lieutenants. Mula Gabharu laid down her life in the battlefield fighting for Bharat's freedom from invaders.

People of Assam celebrate **Mulagabhoru Day** every year on the 29th of May.

The great historian R.C.Majumdar notes, "He (Suhungmung) extended the power of the Ahoms in all directions, and his valiant resistance to the Muslims gave immunity to Assam from further Muslim aggression for 130 years."

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

The Ahoms under Svarga Narayan adopted a process of assimilation whenever they conquered new territories. When the Chutiya kingdom was taken over, many families from the Ahom kingdom were resettled in some regions of the other kingdom. Similarly many families from the Chutiya kingdom were settled in the Ahom regions.

Why do you think this was done? Discuss.

BATTLE OF SARAIGHAT

MUGHALS EYE ASSAM

The Ahom kingdom flourished. After Svarga Narayan's victory over invaders, Assam was quite peaceful. There were regular attempts by the Mughals and their vassals in Bengal to invade Assam but were driven away. The Koch kingdom lay between the Ahoms and the Mughals and when Koch got into an alliance with the Mughals, the Ahoms were attacked again. After 1658 CE, Aurangzeb took over the Mughal throne and wanted to occupy the whole of Assam. Frequent conflicts culminated in a major showdown between the Ahoms and the Mughals at Saraighat in 1671 CE.



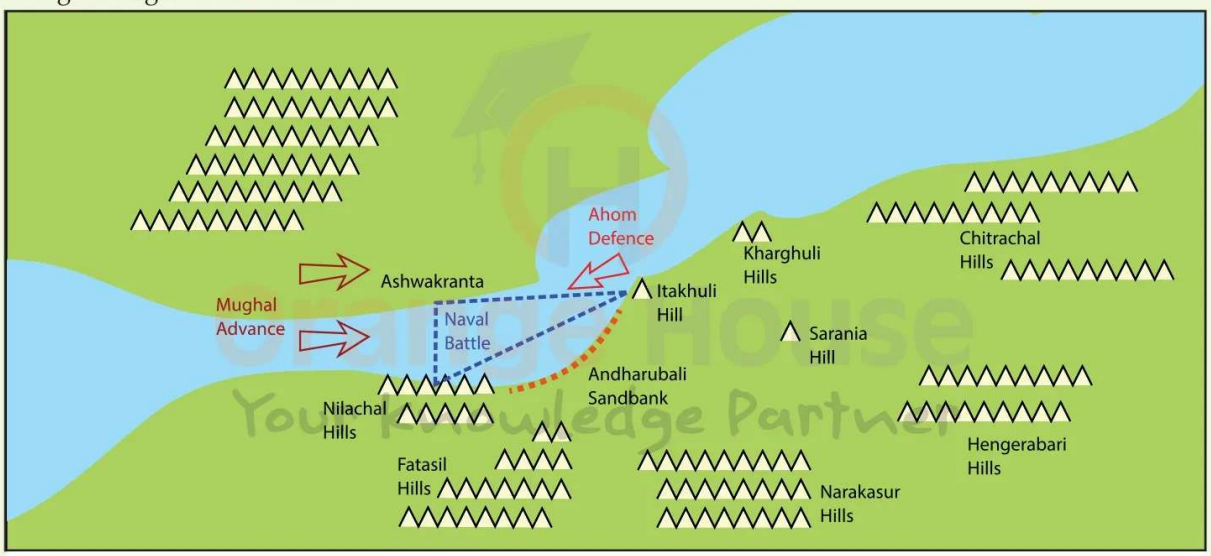
Lachit Borpukhan

SARAIGHAT - THE BATTLEGROUND

The Mughals ordered Ram Singh to head their very large army of more than 40,000 infantry and 20,000 cavalry. The Ahoms ruled by Raja Chakradwaj Singha appointed Lachit Borpukhan as the commander in chief of the Ahoms army. This battle was very unique because besides being fought on land, it was primarily fought in the Brahmaputra river.

PLANNING AND PREPARATION

The Mughal forces greatly outnumbered the small Ahom army. Lachit was very familiar with the topography of his homeland. The rains and slushy mountain slopes near Guwahati worked well for Lachit's guerilla style warfare. He attacked the Mughals when they least expected and quickly retreated into the mountains. The Mughals had a large navy made up of large boats filled with warriors. The Ahoms and Lachit knew the river systems very well and constructed many forts and posts at key places along the river, especially at the points where the river was narrow. The Ahoms ensured that these forts provided a significant defence against the invading Mughals. Lachit made mud embankments so that the Mughal navy couldn't traverse some of the shallow portions of the river. A ring of defence posts were constructed around the hills to protect Guwahati. Near present day Guwahati, the Brahmaputra is at its narrowest. Lachit used this point to cutoff and guard against the invaders.



Battle of Saraighat

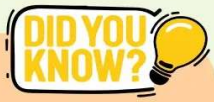
SMOOTH EXECUTION

Lachit knew the flow, depth and narrowness of the river and had different tactics to take on the Mughal navy at the different places. The Mughal navy had 40 large war boats with more than 15 guns in each boat manned by Mughal and European sailors. The Ahom navy was designed with small, nimble boats on which small guns/canons were fixed. While this meant that the Ahom boats had to be in close range of the Mughal boats to fire, their boats could easily navigate through the narrow parts of the river. Lachit had converted the entire river system into a large arena for the battle. With the guerilla attacks in the mountains and sharp attacks in the river using the nimble canon mounted Ahom navy, they made the Mughals suffer.

BATTLE OF SARAIGHAT	
When?	March 1671 CE
Where?	Brahmaputra river, Saraighat, Assam
Who were the combatants?	
Ahoms	Mughals
Who were the commanders?	
Chakradwaj Singha, Lachit Borpukhan	Ram Singh
Outcome : Ahom victory	
SIGNIFICANCE : Ahoms reestablish their power around Guwahati	

UNEXPECTED CHALLENGE

At a crucial juncture, Lachit fell sick. The Mughals tried to use this to their advantage, but Lachit immediately entered the battle and lifted the morale of the Ahoms. His effective navigation through the river and orders to his skilled sailors trumped the Mughal navy. The Ahoms drove the Mughals out and pursued them past the Manas river. Completely routed and having suffered great losses of men and resources the Mughals met their match at the hands of the Ahoms under the leadership of Lachit Borpukhan.



It is said that Lachit Borphukan had ordered his uncle to complete a key fortification task to protect Guwahati by the next morning. When Lachit inspected it in the morning and found it unfinished, he ordered his uncle to be beheaded for not having done his duty to protect Guwahati. This place is called Momai Kota Garh.

Aurangzeb could never see Assam under Mughal rule. The Ahoms had successfully thwarted Mughal invasions till the very end.

FROM THE LAND OF TWIPRA (TRIPURA)

The history of the land of Tripura dates to a very early age. Originating in the confluence of the Brahmaputra, Meghna and Surma rivers (in present-day Bangladesh), Tripura has produced some great rulers who have co-existed with the Ahoms. The ancient rulers of Tripura carried the title "pha" that means "father". A 15th century chronicle called the "Rajmala" traces the entire line of rulers of Tripura.

In the 14th century, the kings adopted the title of "Manikya" and this continues till today. In this lineage came one of the greatest kings of the Manikya dynasty, **Vijaya Manikya II**. In 1532, Vijaya Manikya was placed on the throne by the powerful army general Daityanarayana. Daityanarayana intended to rule Tripura using Vijaya Manikya as a puppet. Vijaya Manikya II had Daityanarayana killed and regained power. For the next 26 years he expanded the kingdom. The Cacharis, Jaintiyas that were the neighbouring kingdoms paid tributes to Vijaya Manikya. On seeing his growing power, the sultan of Bengal attacked Tripura. Adopting guerilla style warfare, the large armies of the Bengal sultan were defeated. On his victory, Vijaya Manikya II paid his respects to the family deity of the Manikya kings called the temple of the Fourteen Gods (Chaturdasha Devata). This temple is situated in Udaipur in Tripura

Your knowledge Partner

UNAKOTI - A MYSTERIOUS MARVEL

The famous bas relief structures of Unakoti are located close to Kailashahar, Tripura. Unakoti means "one less than a crore". Legends say that there are 99,99,999 rock cut images of gods and goddesses in the hills of this region of Tripura.

Archaeologists date some of these bas relief structure to be between the 7th and 13th century although there exists many undiscovered sculptures in the hills of the region.



Shiva's sculpture, Unakoti Tripura



Sculpture of Ganesha, Unakoti Tripura

MANIPUR - AHOM'S NEIGHBOUR

THE WORLD'S LARGEST ALL WOMEN MARKET

Further away from the Ahom kingdom was the region of Manipur. A unique symbol of Manipur's history is the Ima Keithel. Ima Keithel translates to "mother's market". What is so special about this market? This is the world's largest all-women market where more than 5,000 traders have their stalls. This was not a market started now. This market dates to the 16th century.





DID YOU KNOW?

Sagol Kangei originated in Manipur. Sagol means "pony" and Kangei means "game of sticks". King Kangba invented the game before the Common Era. The first polo match was organized by King Nongda Pakhangba in 33 CE. This game is deeply entrenched in the culture of Manipur. It is played during the Manipuri Meitei festival of Lai Haraoba. The Marjing temple is dedicated to the God of Horses, Iboudou Marjing. Marjing is not just God of horses and war but also of polo!



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CONCLUSION

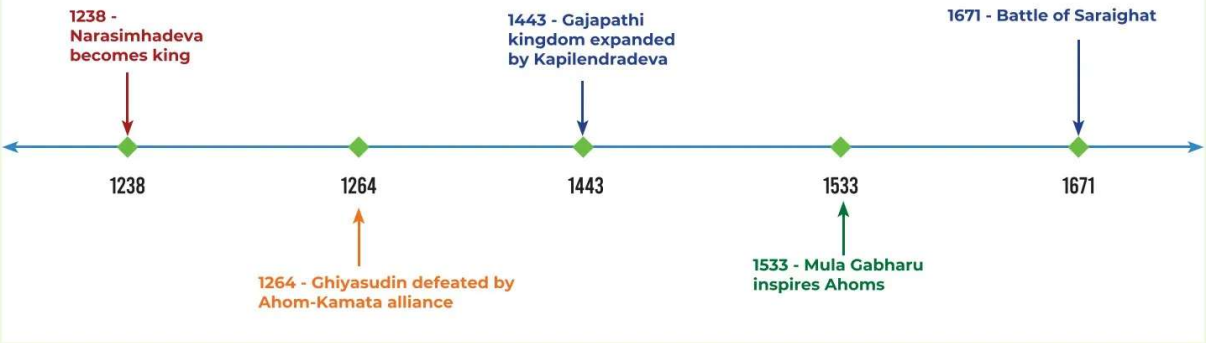
The eastern and north-eastern empires of Bharat had great and brave rulers who protected the nation from external aggressors. The Eastern Ganga rulers rendered stupendous service to the nation giving Bharat great architectural marvels. The Ahoms were able to stave away the invaders for more than 500 years. The resilience of the people of these regions have helped in a thriving culture that has survived time. The mighty Brahmaputra that flows in the region has seen some of the fiercest battles including the battle of Saraighat that revealed a hero - Lachit Borpukhan. Western powers were to gain strength in the coming years and eastern Bharat was to experience new challenges.

****

KEYWORDS

- Eastern Ganga
- Narasimhadeva I
- Konark
- Tugril Khan
- Gajapati
- Musunuri Nayaks
- Puri Jagannath Temple
- Iliyas Shah
- Reddis
- Raja Kapilendra
- Vishakapatnam
- Hamvira
- Udayagiri. Ahoms
- Manikya
- Kamata
- Tripura,Sukapha
- Suhungmung
- Mula Gabharu
- Ima Keithel
- Battle of Saraighat
- Ram Singh
- Lachit Borpukhan
- Brahmaputra

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. _____ served as the capital of the Eastern Ganga kingdom.
   a) Amer b) Cuttack c) Sambalpur d) Balasore
2. In 1238 CE, _____ became the ruler of the Eastern Ganga kingdom.
   a) Bhanudeva I b) Narasimhadeva I c) Kumaradeva I d) Naradeva
3. From the time of Narasimhadeva I, the rulers of the Eastern Ganga kingdom adopted the title of:
   a) Raja b) Maharaja c) Gajapati d) Rashtrapati
4. Narasimha II was assisted by _____ when he was a young prince.
   a) Narahari Tirtha b) Raja Tirtha c) Sumaka d) Iliyas Shah
5. The Puri Jagannath temple was ransacked by _____ during the time of Narasimhadeva III.
   a) Ibrahim Lodi b) Iliyas Shah c) Sikandar Shah d) Jorhat Shah
6. Bhanudeva was freed from the hold of the Malwa sultan _____.
   a) Hushang b) Boryang c) Nepri d) Floyung
7. True or False:
   Statement A: Turbak Khan lost against the Ahom forces in the battle of Lakhnauti
   Statement B: Ahoms used fire-arms to win over Turbak Khan in the battle of Lakhnauti
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) A & B are false d) A & B are true
8. Which Ahom king assumed the title Svarga Narayan
   a) Sudangpha b) Suhungmung c) Sukapha d) Suteupha
9. Sangol Kangei means _____
   a) A dish cooked with sticks b) A song played with sticks
   c) Game of sticks played on a pony d) War tactics using sticks seated on a pony

NAME THE DYNASTY OF THE FOLLOWING PEOPLE

- Vijaya Manikya II
- Raja Chakradwaj Sinha
- Ram Singh
- Bhajani
- Mula Gabharu
- Svarg Narayan
- Durlabh Narayan

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ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. Who was the governor of Bengal during the time of Narasimhadeva II?
2. What led to the beginning of the Gajapati rule in Odisha?
3. Who is Nilambara and what are his achievements?
4. How did Mula Gabharu inspire the Ahom army?
5. Why was the Sultan of Bengal Ghiyasudin Azam Shah not able to take over Kamata kingdom?
6. What is special about the Ima Keithal?
7. Why did the Tripura kings add 'pha' to their titles?

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. Explain the method of finding time using the wheel in the Konark sun temple.
2. How did Narasimhadeva I expand his kingdom?
3. What led to the shattering of the power and prestige of the Eastern Ganga royal family?
4. Who contributed to the expansion of the Gajapati kingdom? Cite examples and explain
5. How did the Ahoms defeat the large army and naval force of Turbak Khan? What was the outcome of this battle?
6. What happened at the battle of Saraighat? What tactics did Lachit Borpukan use to drive away the mighty Mughals?

CASE STUDY

The Mughals and Ahoms faced off at Saraighat. The Mughal navy had 40 large war boats with more than 15 guns in each boat manned by Mughal and European sailors.The Ahom navy was designed with small, nimble boats on which small guns/canons. The Mughals ordered Ram Singh to head their very large army of more than 40,000 infantry and 20,000 cavalry. The Mughal forces greatly outnumbered the small Ahom army. But, the Ahoms were heavily reliant on guerilla warfare.

1. Were the large battleships of the Mughals helpful in the battle? How did the nimble boats add to the Ahoms' advantage?
2. How did the small army of the Ahoms match up to the massive army led by Ram Singh?
3. Did the geography of Saraighat influence the battle?

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